Career Planning and Development

Session Objectives

- Understand the concept of career and know the significance and nuances of career in organizations
- Understand the nuances of creating a career policy and a career management structure and mechanism

Concept of Career

A career is all the jobs that are held during ones working life.

Edwin B. Flippo defined a career *as "a sequence of separate but related work activities that provide continuity, order and meaning in a person life."*

Douglas T. Hall defined a career as "an individually perceived sequence of attitude and behaviors associated with work related experiences and activities over the span of the person life."

Article - Multiple Stories to Career Building

Key takeaways from the article

- Concept of Career as a continuous upward progression on a pre-set track barely exists anymore
- Careers are recognised as winding paths shaped according to various stages and cycles of a person's lifetime. No longer a rat race
- Not dependent on recognition by others
- Radical trends in markets , products and society
- Investing in knowledge that cannot be used across industries or companies is fruitless
- Organizations need to provide Professional challenge and support
- Four ways of providing professional development include – feasible flexibility, development-oriented relationships, visibility and transparency and diversity management

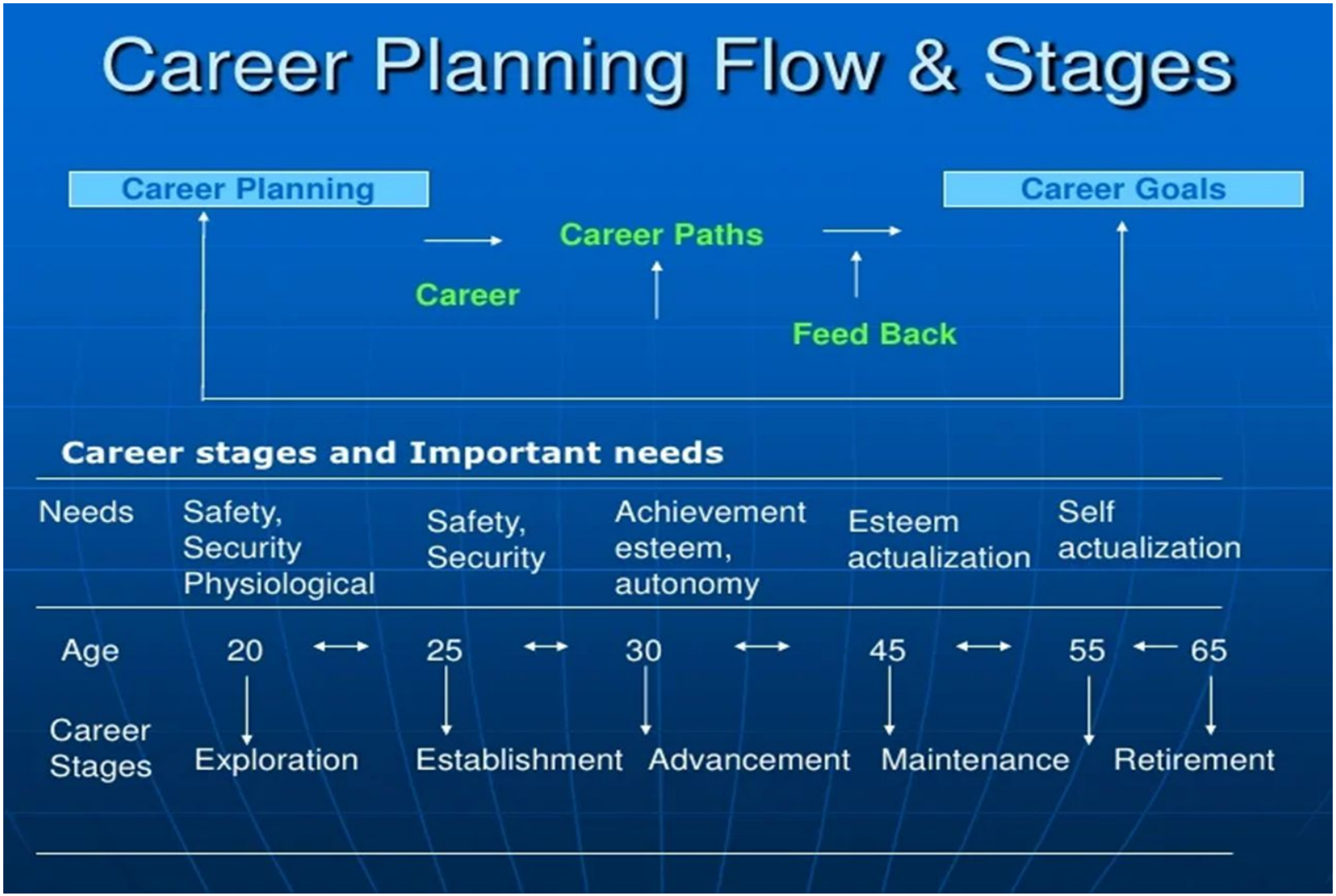
Key factors governing Career today

- Reinvent ourselves
- Work life balance
- Match my interests – be in alignment with my personal orientation and also personal needs
- Should be a reflection and shaper of my self image
- Align with social background is not a necessity- Socio-economic status, education and occupational status of a person's parents
- Concept of Protean career – read article

Career Planning

- "Career Planning is a deliberate process of becoming aware of self, opportunities, constraints, choices, and consequences; identifying career-related goals; and "career pathing" or programming work, education, and related developmental experiences to provide the direction, timing, and sequence of steps to attain a specific career goal." {McMahon and Merman: 1987)

Career Planning flow and stages



Career Planning flow and stages

- Exploration Stage- college to work- understanding organization and young people with the help of internship, on-the-job training, self exploration – helps in career planning.
- Establishment Stage- search for first job, experience on the job, peer group evaluations, committing mistakes, learning from mistakes and increase in responsibilities.
- Mid-Career Stage- age between 35 to 50, improved performance, no longer learner, no longer ambitious, organization can place him on jobs, which require experience and maturity.
- Late Career Stage- stage where one relaxes a bit, time to command respect from younger employees, experience and judgement are greatly valued.
- Decline Stage- Attention may turn to withdrawal/retirement.

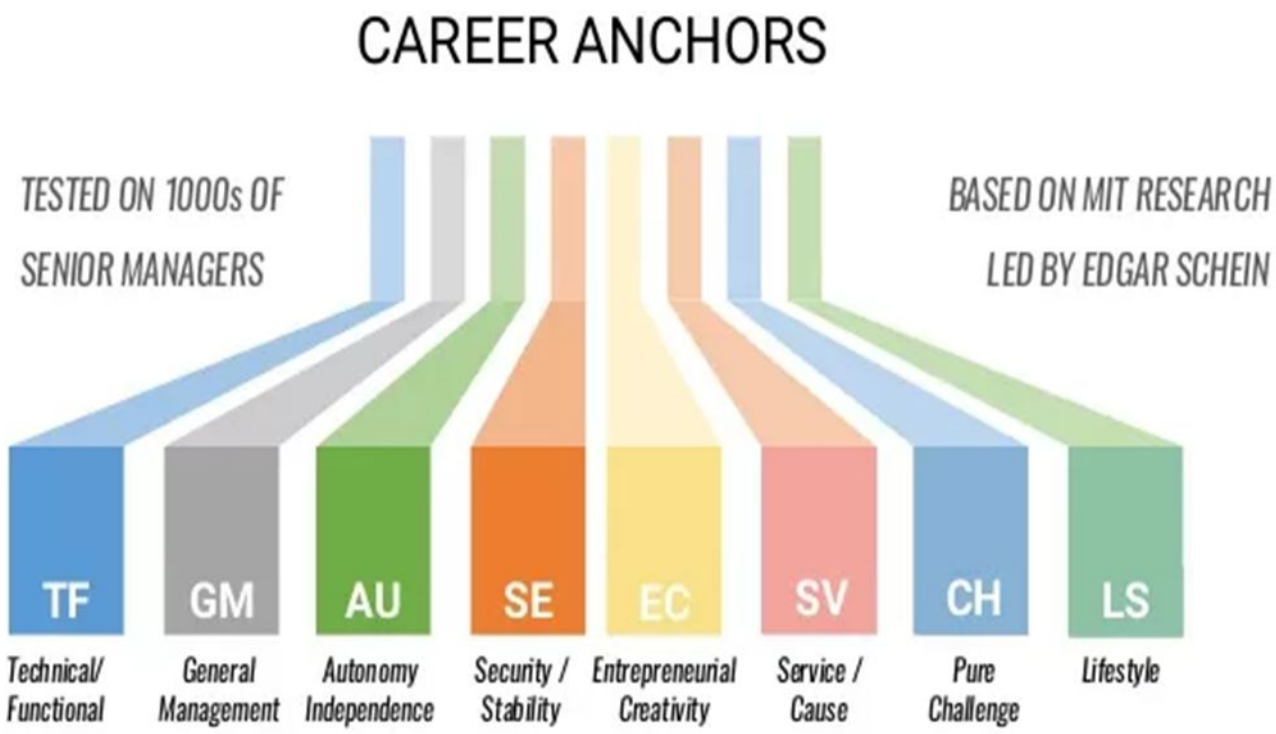
Career Anchors

- In a research conducted by Schein, it was discovered that certain attitudinal syndromes that served to guide many people throughout their careers were formed early in life.

- These syndromes were composed of a combination of needs, values, and talents, and serve to “anchor” the person to one or a few related types of careers.

- There are eight such identified anchors.

Career Anchors



Know what is your anchor – take the Career Orientation Inventory test

Limitations to Career Planning

- Precise Long-Term Careers.
- Applicable to Mid/Large scale orgs only.
- To Loyal employees only.
- Dual Career Families
- Low Ceiling Careers
- Declining Career opportunities
- Downsizing / Right sizing

Career Development

- Career development is the proactive, lifelong series of activities (such as workshops) that contribute to a person's career exploration, establishment, success, and fulfilment
- Concept of an ideal worker
  - Seek high-profile assignments.
  - Rub shoulders with influential leaders.
  - Communicate openly and directly about career aspirations.
  - Seek visibility for their accomplishments.
  - Let their supervisors know of their skills and willingness to contribute.
  - Seek opportunities continually.
  - Learn the political landscape or unwritten rules of the organization.

Hurdles to Career Development

- Performance
- Exposure
- Networking
- Leveraging
- Loyalty to Career
- Mentors & Sponsors
- Key subordinates
- Expand ability

Career Management

- Career management is the process of planning an employee's progress towards a professional goal and then acting on those plans through a variety of methods. There are several entities involved in career management, including the employee, their manager, HR and/or a specialized L&D team or leader, and the organization.
- If individual employees have not planned well for their own development, they may not be ready or willing to respond to opportunities presented through organizational career management activities. Similarly, no amount of individual career planning and preparation will be effective if organizational opportunities for career movement are not available.

Career Management Principles

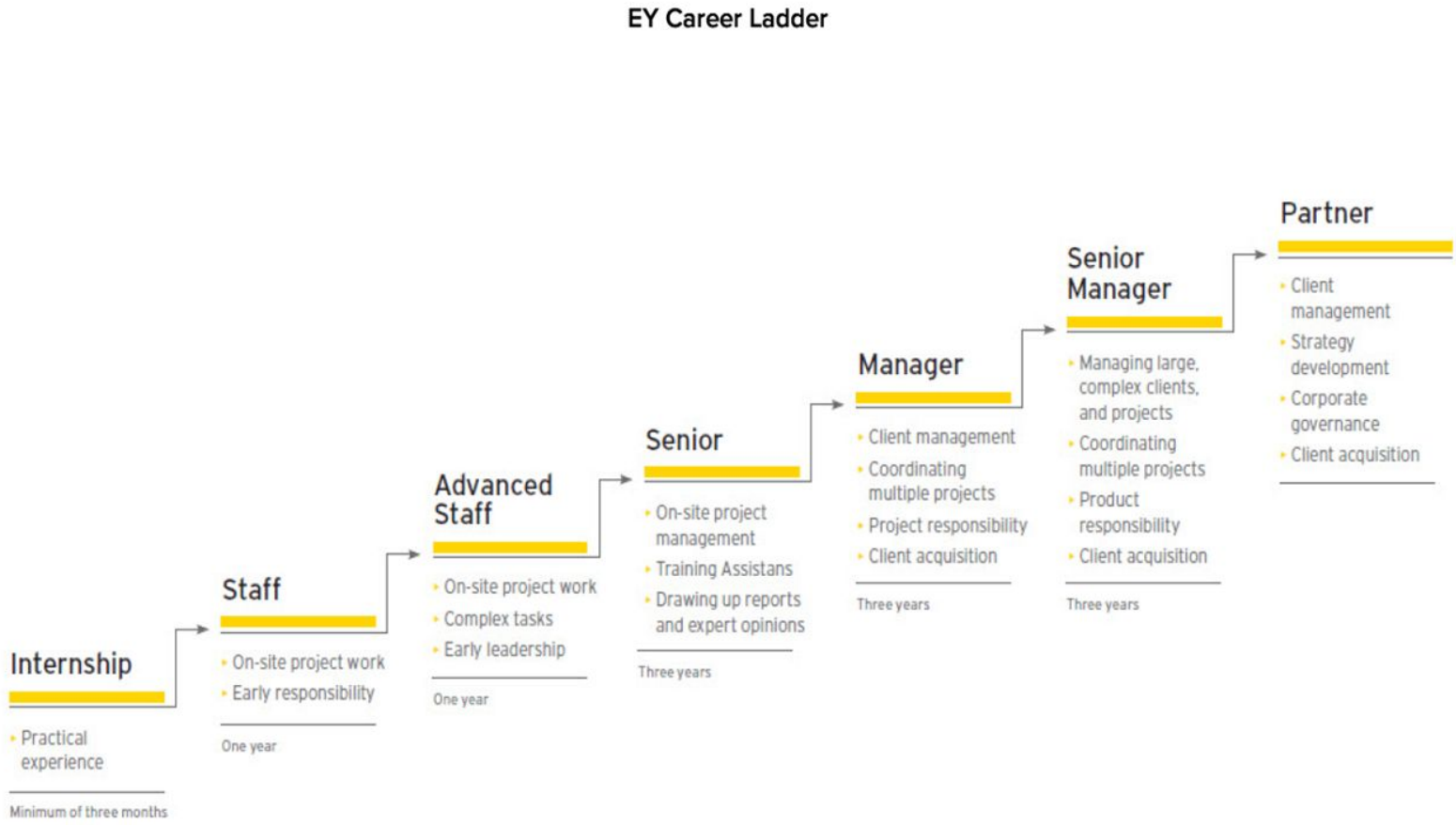
- Preparation of a manpower plan showing future replacement needs and long-term potential of different categories of employees.
- Job Vacancies with detailed job descriptions in the information domain thro' notifications
- Policy considerations to clear the way for interdepartmental or interunit transfers, avoid the blockage of promotion paths and outwardly support career reinforcing activities
- Job-progression ladders, and individual career-pathing procedures are essential if the internal organization mechanism of career planning and development is to work
- Identifying employees (through performance and potential appraisals) who have the necessary ability and willingness to climb up the ladder.
- Exposing employees to different functions/roles to enable them to find out their best career options.
- Making employees aware of the competencies needed for different career options.
- Formulating and implementing training and development plans. Appraisal interviews, counselling etc. to prepare employees for higher rungs of their career ladders.
- Periodically reviewing the career development plan.

Career Paths and Ladders

- Career ladders are the progression of jobs in an organization's specific occupational fields ranked from highest to lowest based on level of responsibility and pay.
- Career paths encompass varied forms of career progression, including the traditional vertical career ladders, dual career ladders, horizontal career lattices, career progression outside the organization and encore careers.

Read article – Developing Employee Career Paths and Ladders

Traditional Career Path



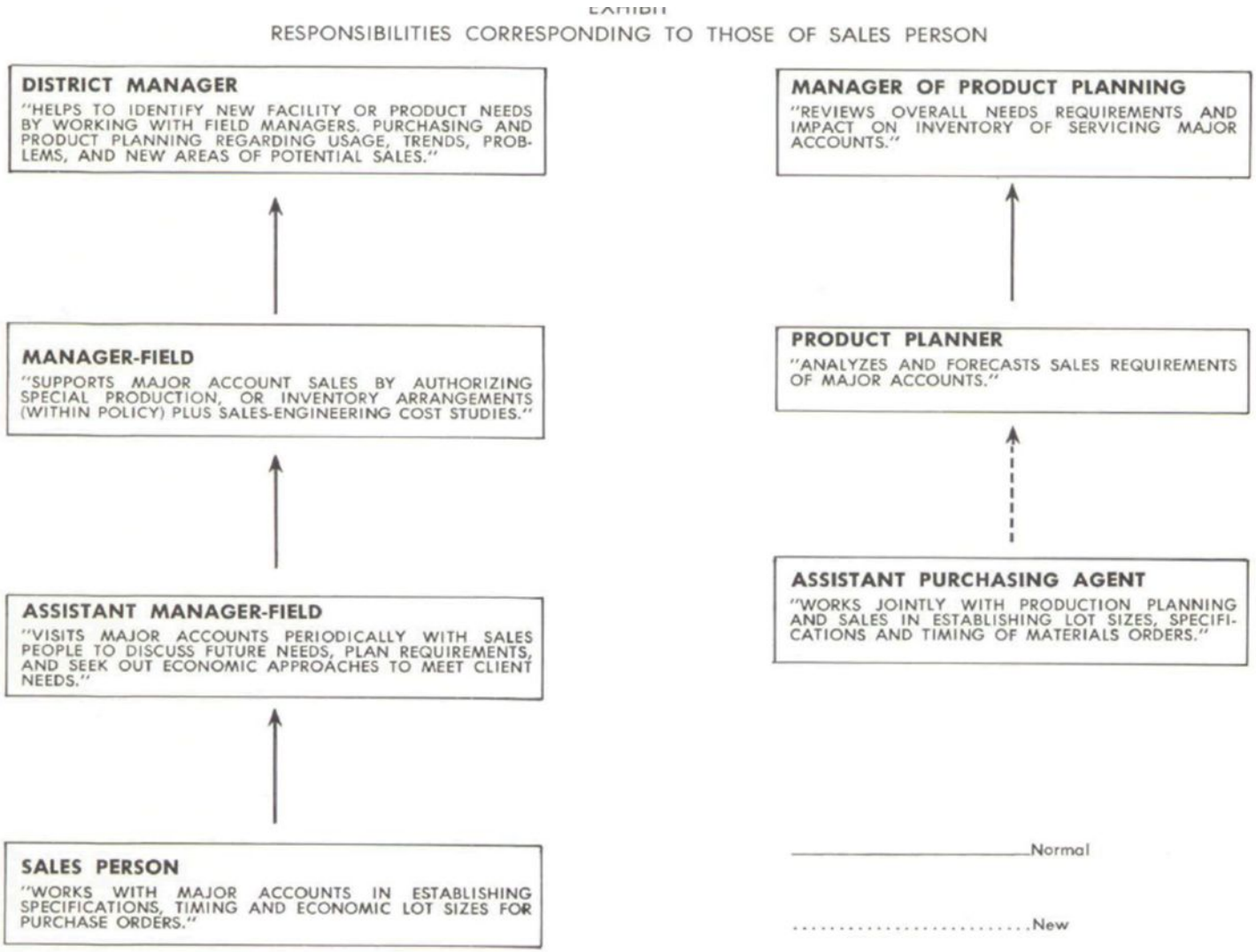
Nontraditional methods of Career Progression

- Job Redesign (Job enrichment , Job enlargement)
- Job Rotation
- Dual career ladders
- Horizontal career paths (career lattices)
- Accelerated and Dialled down career paths
- Encore career paths/Second Careers
- Job Crafting

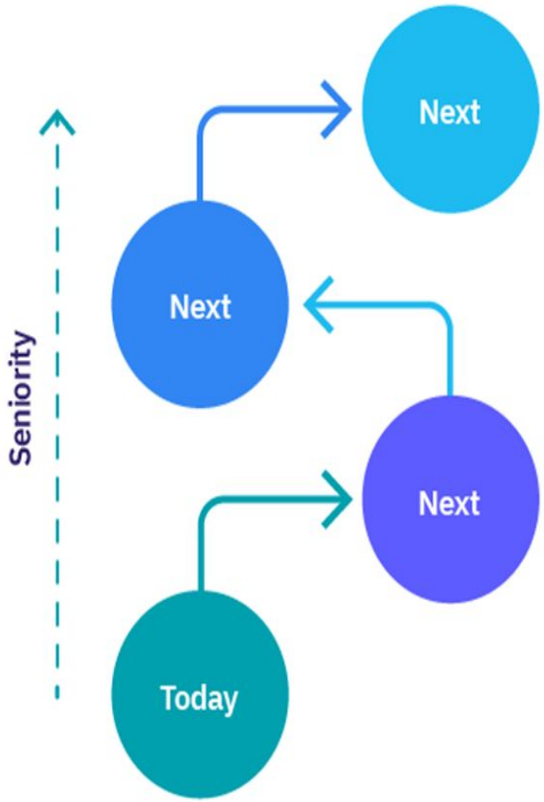
Career Paths outside the organization

- Consultant
- Contingent Work
- Volunteerism
- Sabbaticals

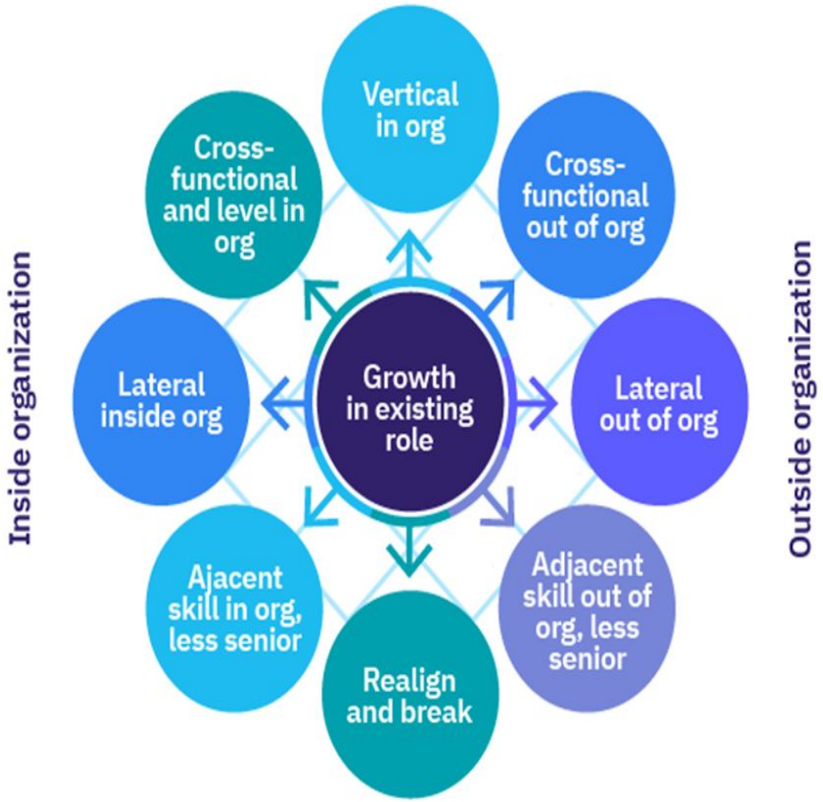
Career Ladder model



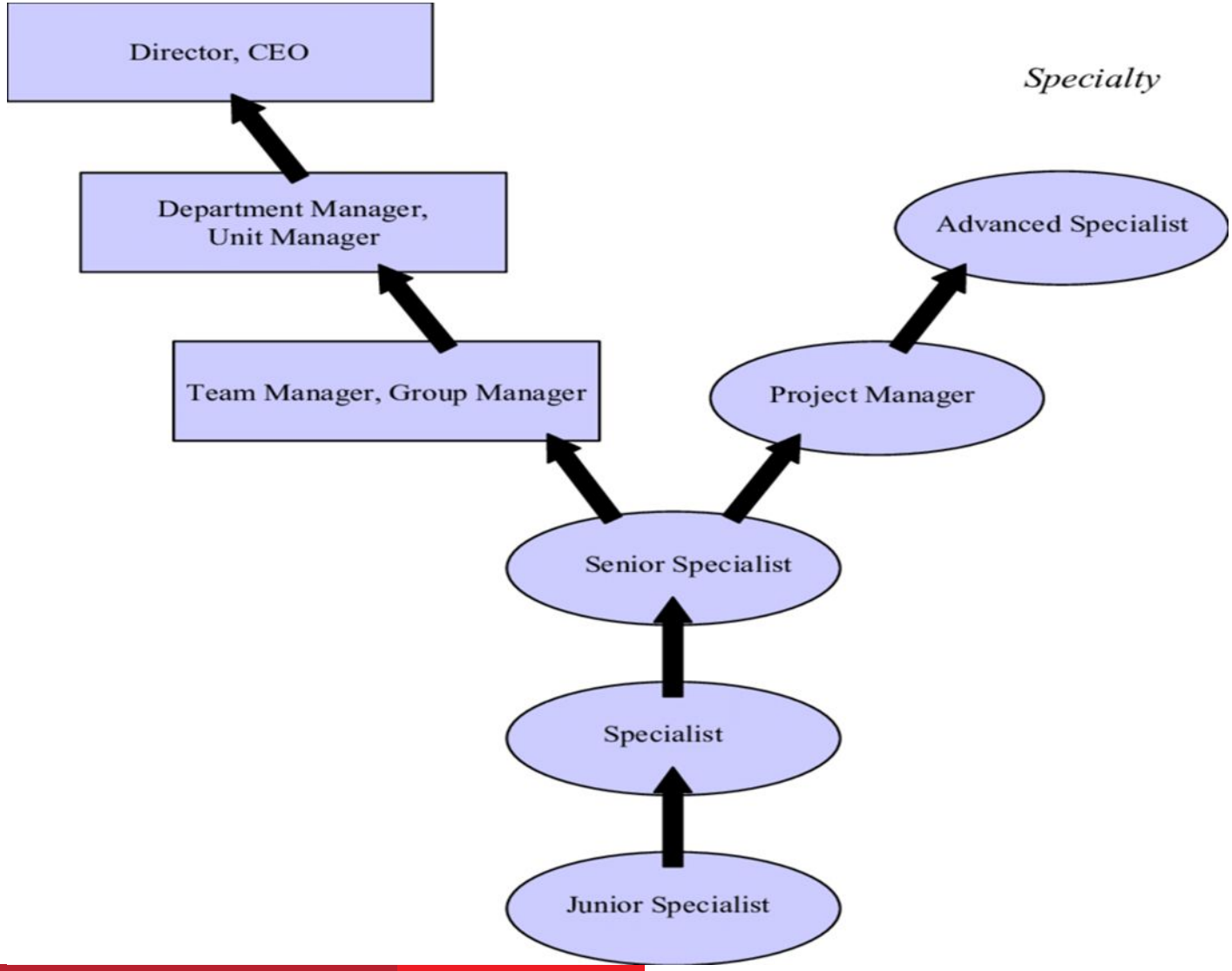
Traditional Career Ladder vs. Career Lattice Approach



Traditional Career Ladder



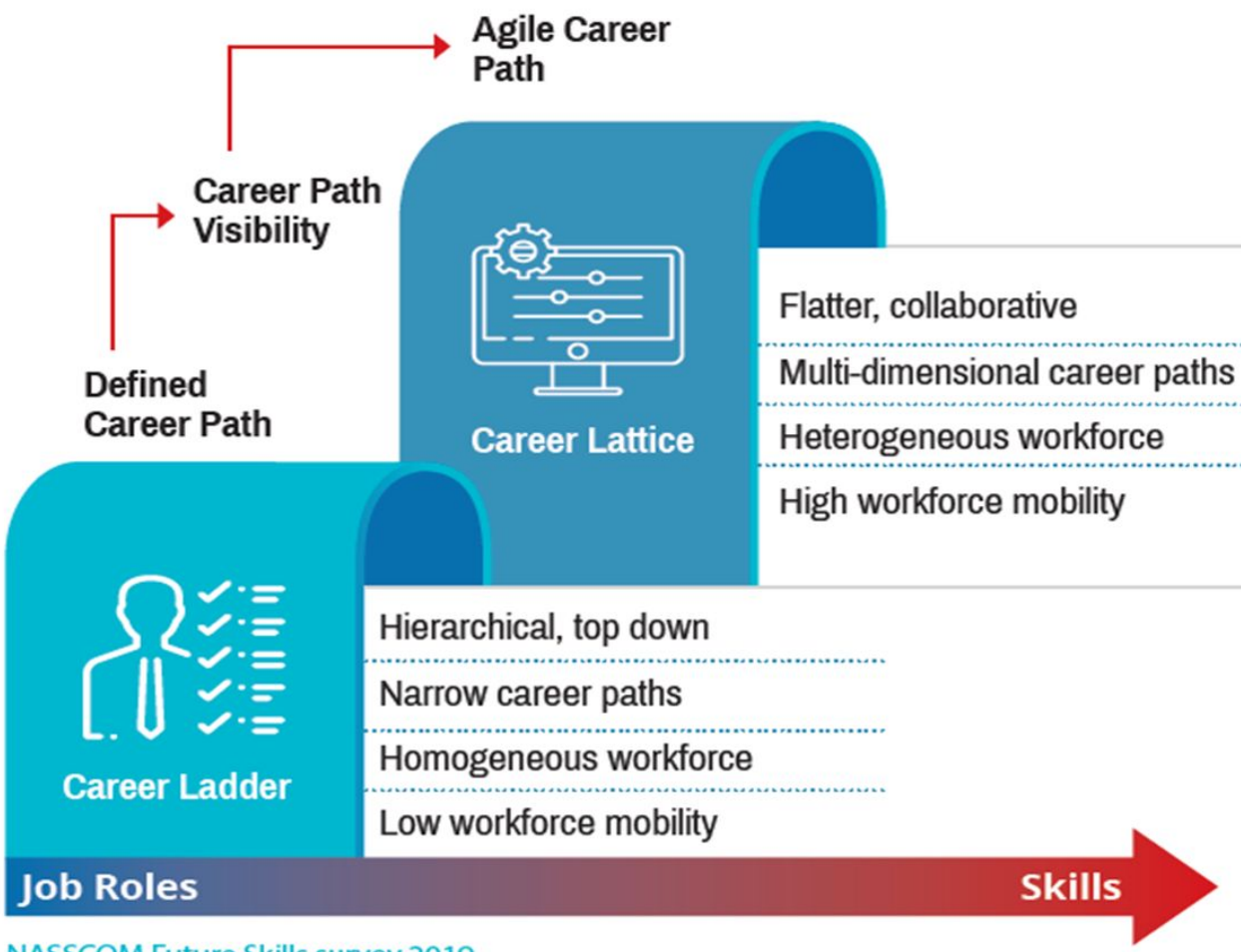
Career Lattice Approach


Director, CEO
Specialty
Department Manager, Unit Manager
Advanced Specialist
Team Manager, Group Manager
Project Manager
Senior Specialist
Specialist
Junior Specialist

Organizational Career Management Practices

- Performance appraisal as a basis for career planning
- Assessment centre
- Peer appraisal
- Upward appraisal
- Career counselling by direct supervisor, HR
- Formal mentoring
- Career workshops
- Common career paths
- Dual career ladder
- Written personal career planning
- Retirement preparation program
- Promotions/Succession Planning
- Books/Pamphlets on career issues
- Postings regarding internal job openings
- Formal education as part of career development
- Lateral moves to create cross functional experience

Evolving career paths



62%
Career paths exist and are visible to employees

10%
Career paths exist however not visible to employees

28%
No clearly defined career paths

NASSCOM Future Skills survey 2019

Employee Life Cycle – Career Management

- Promotions
  - Advancements to positions of increased responsibility
  - Effective promotion strategy – 'Dry Promotions'
  - Gender Gap
  - Establish clear guidelines for Promotion
    - Is seniority or competence the rule?
    - How should we measure competence?
    - Is the process formal or informal?
    - Vertical, horizontal, or other?
- Managing Transfers
- Managing Retirements

Role of a Manager

- Communication
  - Gauging an employee's interest in promotion without promising a specific job.
  - Telling an employee he or she is a high-potential employee.
  - Letting an employee know he or she is not considered a high-potential employee
- Mentoring
  - advising, counseling, and guiding employees' longer-term career development
  - formal or informal
- Coaching
  - focuses on empowering them
- Career management
  - Why should they be loyal?
- Commitment-Oriented career development efforts
  - Career-oriented appraisals
- Awareness about legal issues
  - Gender stereotyping
  - Discriminatory Promotions
  - Pay discrimination

Evaluating Career Programs

- HR professionals should analyze key metrics related to career progression programs to determine the return on investment (ROI) to the organization.
- One way to calculate the ROI for career progression programs is to determine how these initiatives affect organizational turnover or retention rates and then to quantify their impact in financial terms.
- For example, an organization that has higher-than-average turnover rates for employees with three to five years of tenure with the firm may decide to develop individualized career maps as a way to boost retention. If the program reduces turnover rates, then the savings from replacement costs, such as recruiting, orientation and lost productivity, can be calculated.
- The final step in calculating the ROI is to compare the cost of developing and implementing career progression initiatives in terms of staff time or consultant fees to the savings resulting from reduced turnover.
- To illustrate, if the cost of a career progression initiative was $45,000, but the efforts yielded a savings of $75,000 in turnover costs, then the ROI was $30,000

Thank You